

The Information Daily Briefing - 2026-07-29

The Information Daily Briefing — July 29, 2026

Coverage window: the past 24 hours (The Information's July 28, 2026 editions and morning digest), compiled from the subscriber newsletters in Gmail and the logged-in theinformation.com homepage. Prices/valuations are as reported by The Information; nothing here is investment advice.

Top Stories — What / Why / When / Which / How

1. Anthropic accelerates toward a September IPO — but under mounting pressure

- **What:** Anthropic is negotiating new bank credit lines ahead of a possible September IPO at a **\$1 trillion-plus valuation**, is weighing an unusual mandatory employee stock-sale plan, and just secured up to **\$5 billion from AMD** in a new chip deal.
- **Why:** Locking in liquidity and compute supply before a listing strengthens the balance sheet; rival startups are reportedly waiting for Anthropic to list before launching their own IPOs, making Anthropic the bellwether for the AI IPO window.
- **When:** Reported July 28, 2026; IPO targeted as soon as September 2026.
- **Which:** Anthropic (private), AMD, and the banks arranging the credit facility; downstream, the broader tech-IPO pipeline.
- **How:** Adding billions to a syndicated bank credit line, structuring post-IPO employee stock sales, and pairing the raise with an AMD silicon partnership to diversify beyond Nvidia.
- **Link:** <https://www.theinformation.com/articles/anthropic-talks-add-billions-bank-credit-line-ahead-ipo> · <https://www.theinformation.com/briefings/amd-invest-5-billion-anthropic-strikes-chip-deal>

2. Nvidia makes a multibillion-dollar bet on Ilya Sutskever's Safe Superintelligence

- **What:** Nvidia made a “substantial” — multibillion-dollar — investment in **Safe Superintelligence (SSI)**, the secretive lab founded by ex-OpenAI chief scientist Ilya Sutskever, enabling SSI to increase compute **roughly 10x over the next year**.
- **Why:** It deepens Nvidia's strategy of seeding demand for its own chips by funding frontier labs, and validates the “neolab” thesis that new architectures can leapfrog incumbents like OpenAI and Anthropic.
- **When:** Announced Monday, July 27; reported in The Information's July 28 AM digest.
- **Which:** Nvidia (NVDA) and SSI (private; last valued ~\$32B in April 2025, having raised \$3B+ from Greenoaks, Andreessen Horowitz and Sequoia).
- **How:** A direct equity investment tied to a large compute-capacity ramp; SSI says its research is “focused on overlooked aspects of how the human brain functions.”

- **Link:** <https://www.theinformation.com/> (The Information AM, July 28, 2026)

3. China mass-produces homegrown DUV lithography — ASML shares slide ~5%

- **What:** A Chinese state-backed, Shanghai-based company has begun **mass-producing immersion DUV lithography tools** for the first time. On the report, **ASML** shares fell as much as 6.6% and closed down ~5%.
- **Why:** DUV machines are core chipmaking equipment where ASML has been the dominant global supplier; domestic Chinese production threatens ASML's share, and ~30% of ASML's 2025 revenue came from China.
- **When:** Reported July 27–28, 2026.
- **Which:** ASML (ASML) most directly; also TSMC and the broader semiconductor-equipment supply chain; a strategic win for China's self-sufficiency drive.
- **How:** Localization of a previously foreign-controlled tool; if yields scale, it erodes ASML's DUV pricing power and China-exposed revenue.
- **Link:** <https://www.theinformation.com/articles/china-starts-mass-producing-homegrown-duv-chipmaking-tools-advance-local-chip-industry>

4. Cursor customers revolt over price hikes; some defect to Claude Code

- **What:** **Cursor** (which SpaceX plans to buy for ~\$60B) is facing heated renewal fights after shifting to usage-based pricing. One IT firm's renewal quote jumped from ~\$200k to ~\$1.5M before being negotiated to ~\$250k; **Sanofi** and **Druva** were quoted roughly 5x increases.
- **Why:** It shows Cursor lacks the pricing power Anthropic commands — customers say they get “a better deal with Claude Code” — and highlights a broader enterprise push to cut AI spend via open-source “harnesses” and model routers.
- **When:** Reported July 28, 2026.
- **Which:** Cursor (private; SpaceX acquirer), Anthropic (Claude Code), plus cost-cutting enablers like OpenCode, Weave and Pi; customers Sanofi (SNY) and Druva.
- **How:** Enterprises route simple coding tasks to cheaper open-source/small models (Google, OpenAI) and reserve premium Anthropic models for complex work; Sapiom expects ~25% savings, Codestrap cites 97% cost drops on some workloads.
- **Link:** <https://www.theinformation.com/newsletters/applied-ai/cursor-customers-fight-price-hikes-contract-talks>

5. Claude Code keeps its crown despite Codex and open-source pressure

- **What:** Even amid price complaints, **Anthropic's Claude Code remains dominant** in AI coding, having eroded GitHub Copilot and Cursor through late 2025–early 2026; most enterprises are sticking with it despite surging usage-based costs.
- **Why:** Sticky developer workflows and Anthropic-optimized tooling create a moat that OpenAI's improving Codex and cheaper Chinese open-source models have not yet broken.
- **When:** Reported July 28, 2026.
- **Which:** Anthropic, Microsoft/GitHub (MSFT), OpenAI (Codex), Cursor.

- **How:** Claude Code's proprietary harness is tuned to Anthropic models; switching costs and output quality keep enterprises paying even as they experiment with routing.
- **Link:** <https://www.theinformation.com/articles/anthropics-claude-code-reigns-despite-rising-interest-in-codex-open-source-models>

6. OpenAI and Anthropic quietly ally in Washington ahead of the Aug. 1 AI framework

- **What:** Arch-rivals **OpenAI and Anthropic are lobbying jointly** to shape the Trump administration's "frontier model" framework, pushing to make laggards like **Meta** and **xAI** also submit to government model reviews, and to restrict cheap Chinese open-source models.
- **Why:** A 30-day pre-release review could slow the leaders, so they want the same burden applied to rivals; both also face a business threat from Chinese models distilled from their outputs.
- **When:** Framework due to be finalized by **August 1, 2026**; reported July 28.
- **Which:** OpenAI, Anthropic, Meta (META), xAI, Nvidia (which signed a pro-open-source letter), and Chinese labs like Moonshot.
- **How:** Coordinated policy advocacy on model-review thresholds and open-source restrictions; Anthropic stands nearly alone publicly on curbing Chinese models, drawing Silicon Valley pushback.
- **Link:** <https://www.theinformation.com/newsletters/ai-agenda/openai-anthropic-quietly-teaming-washington> · <https://www.theinformation.com/articles/trump-administration-nears-ai-framework-open-source-questions-loom>

7. Moonshot's Kimi K3 trained on restricted Nvidia Blackwell chips; K4 needs more

- **What:** China's **Moonshot AI**, riding the success of **Kimi K3** (the world's largest open-source model at 2.8T parameters), is planning a still-larger **Kimi K4** and is seeking more of Nvidia's advanced **Blackwell** chips — which U.S. rules bar from Chinese firms. K3 was trained on Blackwell chips despite the restrictions.
- **Why:** It confirms export controls are leaking and raises the stakes in the U.S.–China chip fight; Beijing's Commerce Ministry separately rejected U.S. "distillation" and "AI hegemony" accusations.
- **When:** Reported July 28, 2026.
- **Which:** Moonshot AI (private), Nvidia (NVDA), plus the U.S. Bureau of Industry and Security probe.
- **How:** Sourcing restricted chips through channels; the BIS is investigating Chinese firms' access to controlled Nvidia hardware.
- **Link:** <https://www.theinformation.com/articles/chinese-ai-startup-moonshot-seeks-more-nvidia-blackwell-chips-next-model>

8. Microsoft launches "Project Perception" — a cheaper rival to Anthropic's Mythos

- **What:** **Microsoft** unveiled **Project Perception**, an AI cybersecurity product powered partly by its own new **MAI-Cyber-1-Flash** model, framed as a lower-cost alternative to Anthropic's Mythos bug-finding model.

- **Why:** Microsoft is moving to capture rising cybersecurity budgets and reduce reliance on third-party frontier models — another front where Anthropic’s moat is being tested.
- **When:** Announced Monday, July 27; in the July 28 AM digest.
- **Which:** Microsoft (MSFT), Anthropic (Mythos), with the product also drawing on OpenAI and Anthropic models.
- **How:** A homegrown model claimed to match Mythos on some tasks “at a fraction of the cost,” bundled into Microsoft’s overhauled security org.
- **Link:** <https://www.theinformation.com/briefings/exclusive-microsoft-preps-mythos-like-ai-bug-finder>

9. Capital keeps flowing: Jump Capital’s \$350M AI fund and a busy deal sheet

- **What:** **Jump Capital** (backed by Jump Trading’s founders) raised a **\$350M** fund for AI apps, infrastructure and cybersecurity. Elsewhere, **Multiverse Computing** raised \$570M at a \$1.7B valuation; **ChangXin Memory (CXMT)** soared **472%** in its Shanghai debut; and **Amazon** asked the FCC to run a global direct-to-device satellite service (5,105 satellites via Leo/Globalstar).
 - **Why:** Signals sustained appetite for AI/infra despite cost scrutiny, and continued strength in AI-linked public listings in China.
 - **When:** Reported July 27–28, 2026.
 - **Which:** Jump Capital (private), Multiverse Computing, CXMT, Amazon (AMZN), Globalstar (GSAT), Apple (AAPL, which will sell its ~20% Globalstar stake post-deal).
 - **How:** Early-stage checks of \$1–4M/\$8–15M (Jump); Amazon expanding Leo from broadband into satellite-to-phone service after agreeing to buy Globalstar.
 - **Link:** <https://www.theinformation.com/newsletters/dealmaker/startups-angling-go-public-anthropic>
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Overall Market Summary — Trend, Development & Sentiment

Trend. The last 24 hours crystallized three connected storylines: (1) an **AI IPO/liquidity window opening around Anthropic**, (2) an intensifying **U.S.–China semiconductor and model-export battle**, and (3) a decisive shift in enterprise AI toward **cost control** — routing, open-source harnesses, and “cheaper-than-the-leader” products.

Development. Capital and compute are consolidating around the leaders (Nvidia→SSI; AMD→Anthropic; Anthropic’s pre-IPO credit lines) even as those same leaders face margin and moat pressure at the application layer (Cursor’s pricing revolt, Microsoft’s Mythos rival, customers slashing Claude Code spend). Simultaneously, China notched two credibility wins — domestic DUV lithography and Moonshot’s frontier-scale Kimi K3 — that undercut the assumption that export controls guarantee a durable U.S. lead.

Sentiment. Mixed-to-cautiously-bullish on AI demand, but **increasingly skeptical on pricing power and policy risk**. Enthusiasm for infrastructure and frontier labs remains high (record private raises, hot Chinese listings), yet the ASML sell-off and the Nvidia smuggling probe show markets are quick to punish China-exposure and

supply-chain/regulatory headlines. The dominant mood is “demand is real, but who keeps the margin — and who gets regulated — is now the contest.”

Key Questions & Risks

- **Does Anthropic’s IPO actually price at \$1T+, and does it open or close the window for others?** A soft debut would chill the queue of startups waiting behind it. Execution risk is compounded by the Mythos export-control overhang and its lonely stance on Chinese models.
 - **Is Anthropic’s application-layer moat narrowing faster than its revenue is growing?** Cursor’s pain, Microsoft’s cheaper Mythos rival, “it’s the harness, not the model” cost-cutting, and data showing Anthropic isn’t the customer-service leader all point to margin compression risk if usage-based pricing pushes customers to routing.
 - **How much have export controls actually failed?** Moonshot training K3 on Blackwell chips and China mass-producing DUV tools suggest leakage and localization are both accelerating — a structural risk for ASML’s China revenue and for the U.S. policy premium embedded in Nvidia’s narrative.
 - **Regulatory whiplash:** The Aug. 1 frontier framework, a voluntary-but-not-really 30-day review, and possible bans on Chinese models could slow product cadence for the leaders and create compliance risk for enterprises routing workloads through Claude.
 - **Pricing-power divergence:** Anthropic still commands premium pricing while Cursor cannot — but both are shifting to usage-based models just as customers get better at arbitraging cost. Who blinks first?
 - **Geopolitical tail risks:** The Taiwan detention of an Nvidia employee (Supermicro-linked smuggling probe) and Beijing’s “AI hegemony” rhetoric raise the odds of further enforcement actions and retaliation.
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Potential Investment Implications (companies directly mentioned)

Directional reads only, not recommendations or advice. Do your own diligence.

- **Nvidia (NVDA):** Double-edged. The SSI investment reinforces its demand-seeding flywheel and Vera Rubin ramp momentum, but the Moonshot/Blackwell leakage story, the Taiwan smuggling probe, and China’s DUV progress add export-control and enforcement risk to the bull case.
- **ASML (ASML):** Most exposed to the day’s negative catalyst. Domestic Chinese DUV production directly threatens ~30% China revenue and long-run pricing power; watch for order/guidance commentary.
- **AMD (AMD):** Positive read-through. The up-to-\$5B Anthropic chip deal is a tangible AI-accelerator design win and a credibility marker against Nvidia’s dominance.
- **Microsoft (MSFT):** Incrementally positive. Project Perception monetizes rising security budgets with in-house models, reducing reliance on third-party frontier labs — though GitHub Copilot continues to cede coding share to Claude Code.

- **Amazon (AMZN) / Apple (AAPL) / Globalstar (GSAT):** Amazon's global direct-to-device satellite ambition (Leo + Globalstar) expands its connectivity TAM; Globalstar is central to the deal; Apple monetizes and exits its ~20% Globalstar stake once the acquisition closes (targeted 2027).
 - **Super Micro (SMCI) / TSMC (TSM):** Headline/enforcement risk — Supermicro-linked smuggling probe widens; TSMC sits downstream of the ASML/DUV localization shift.
 - **Sanofi (SNY) / Salesforce (CRM):** Named enterprise AI buyers — Sanofi is a Cursor customer weighing a switch to Claude Code (a proxy for enterprise cost discipline); Salesforce made a strategic investment in website startup Solomei AI.
 - **Alphabet/Google (GOOGL) & OpenAI (private):** Beneficiaries of the "route to cheaper/smaller models" trend, as harnesses push simpler coding tasks to Google and OpenAI models.
 - **Private/venture watch:** Anthropic (pre-IPO, ~\$1T+), Safe Superintelligence (~\$32B), Cursor (SpaceX ~\$60B acquirer), Moonshot AI, Multiverse Computing (\$1.7B), CXMT (Shanghai +472%), BitGo (public this year at ~\$2B) — all signal where private AI capital is concentrating.
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- Exclusive: Jump Capital Raises \$350 Million Fund for AI Investments (Dealmaker) — <https://www.theinformation.com/newsletters/dealmaker/jump-capital-raises-350-million-fund-ai-investments>

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